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STOP AGREEING WITH THE SELLER'S NUMBER.

The exact sentence that wins the listing and still lets you sell it.

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Keeping It Real Podcast

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**YOU'RE IN THE
KITCHEN. THE
COMPS DON'T
SUPPORT THE
NUMBER. YOU SAY
YES ANYWAY.**

Here's the one sentence that changes what happens next.

MORE THAN 3 POINTS.

Realtor.com's June 2026 timing analysis found homes that go under contract around week four sell 1.8 percent closer to asking than the average home in the same period. Homes still sitting at week eighteen close 1.3 percent under it, a spread of more than three percentage points. The average home now closes under asking, reversing the pandemic-era pattern. The gap isn't the market moving. It's the number agreed to before there was anything to negotiate.

THE SWAP, FOR YOUR NEXT LISTING APPOINTMENT:

- 1 Don't repeat the seller's number back as agreement.**
Say this first: "I'll tell you what it's worth, and I won't tell you what you want to hear."
- 2 Don't blame the market for a number you agreed to.**
The comps set the number. The appointment doesn't.
- 3 Don't wait for thin showings to prove you wrong.**
A listing still sitting past week four is already telling the seller something you didn't want to say at the table.
- 4 Don't confuse losing the appointment with losing the listing.**
You can win a listing with somebody else's number. You just can't sell it.

THE TAKEAWAY

**WRITE THE
SENTENCE DOWN.
SAY IT BEFORE YOU
GIVE A NUMBER.**

You can win a listing with somebody else's number.
You just can't sell it.